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50 Tips & Tricks



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Enhance

Learning New Languages

Nash David

With a global village like ours, what better role in your life can we as your technology navigator play, than making it an even friendlier place! We believe learning newer languages always forge better ties and improve relationships irrespective of barriers. No longer should a Spanish *dama* hesitate to learn how to make *aloo parathas* from her new online friend, a traditional *kudi* from Amritsar. Besides, our very own Mr. Chattopadhyaya from our good old City of Joy, should not feel dumbstruck when negotiating on a deal in not-too-far Thailand.

The Learning Process

There is no single or perfect way to learning. Needs differ, and so do solutions. There are various methods you can adopt to learn a new language. You may go the purist's way of systematically learning the alphabet, then mastering words, and then moving over to sentences. Finally, cautiously proceeding

through getting the grammar right. On the other hand, some people believe in being practical, that is, getting straight to the point—learning what you need in daily conversations, and then managing your way through life! Finally, there is one more path you can choose in your quest to overcome your hurdles because of inferior linguistic skills. Make new friends, who speak the language of your choice, and by mutual sharing, enhance your skills. Sounds good... right?

The Learning Resources

If those learn-in-30-day-books were really all that effective, this article would not be warranted, neither would there be a vast storehouse of resources available online. We believe you're already aware that there is no shortcut to success, but hard work. We're just showing you where and how to get there. In the bouquet of offerings that the Internet provides, we present three valuable sites—BBC Languages (www.bbc.co.uk/languages), Live Mocha (www.livemocha.com) and Before You Know It (www.byki.com).

You got the whole world in your hands..., and so the song goes. It sounds familiar too. This is, certainly a small world getting even smaller, in the Internet age



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